Nursing in the past Nightingale era turned into a more respectable job with schooling systems and uniforms for nurses. Nurses had to wear a hat and band to distinguish themselves as nurses and display their nursing rank. Fresh nurse students would wear ribbon bands of pink, blue, or other pastel colours. Senior nurses and nursing teachers would wear black ribbon bands to indicate seniority.



1.5 Nursing as a profession – A New Perspective.

DO YOU KNOW?

Nursing is a profession within the health care sector focused on the care of individuals, families, and communities so they may attain, maintain, or recover optimal health and quality of life

Historically, only medicine, law and Engineering were accepted as profession.

1.5.1 Criteria of a profession

Genevieve and Roy Bixler first wrote about the status of nursing as a profession in 1945. These criteria include the following.

1. **The services provided are vital to humanity and the welfare of the society:** Nursing is the service that is essential to the wellbeing of the people and to the society.
2. **There is a special body of knowledge that is continually enlarged through research**: In the past nursing was based on principles borrowed from the physical and social sciences and other disciplines. Today there is unique body of knowledge to nursing.
3. **The services involve intellectual activities:** Nursing process is a cognitive activity that requires both critical and creative thinking and serves as the basis of providing nursing care.
4. **Practitioners are educated in institution of higher learning**: There are basic nursing program, baccalaureate program, masters and Doctoral program in nursing
5. **Practitioners are relatively independent and control their own policies and activities (Autonomy):** Nursing actions are independent, most nurses are employed in hospitals where authority resides in one's position.
6. **Practitioners are motivated by service (altruism) and considered their work an important component of their lives:** Nurses are dedicated to the ideal services to others, which is known as altruism.
7. **There is a code of Ethics to guide the decisions and conduct of Practitioners:** The International council of Nurses (ICN) has established Code of Nursing Ethics through which standards of practice are established, promoted and refined.
8. **There is an organization (Association) that encourage**

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